

Bedtime Tales

Hugo the Hedgehog's Gentle Hug



KIDS BOOK VIDEOS



Hugo was a small brown hedgehog who lived under a mossy log at the edge of Willowmere Wood. He had soft fur on his tummy, but his back was covered in sharp little prickles. He loved his friends very much — Mimi the mouse, Fern the frog — but he never gave hugs, afraid his prickles would poke. "I would hurt them," he whispered. He wanted to hug more than anything, and that made him sad.

One afternoon, Mimi the mouse came to visit with blackberry jam sandwiches. "Thank you for sharing your log with me," she said. Then she opened her arms wide. "Can I have a hug, Hugo?"



Hugo's heart went thump thump. His prickles stood up straight with fear. "I might poke you," he said.



Mimi smiled. "We will find a gentle way," she said. "Gentle and slow, that's the way to go."



"Gentle and slow, that's the way to go." Hugo repeated it softly.
"Gentle and slow, that's the way to go." It became their special saying.



Mimi showed him a trick. "First, I hug your soft tummy side," she explained. "Then you wrap your little arms around me. And we go gentle and slow."



Hugo tried it. He turned his soft side toward Mimi and wrapped his arms around her. Gentle and slow. It worked! No pokes at all — just a warm, cozy hug. "I did it!" he squeaked, feeling happy and brave.



Can you give yourself a gentle hug? Wrap your arms around you, gentle and slow. Just like Hugo.



Next, Fern the frog hopped over. "Hug for me too?" she asked. Hugo nodded and used his trick again. Gentle and slow. Fern giggled. "Best hug ever," she said. Hugo hugged all his friends that day, each hug gentle and slow.



That night, the moon rose round and bright. Hugo curled into a ball under his log while Mimi snuggled beside him, safe from prickles. "Goodnight, gentle hugger," she whispered. Hugo smiled in his sleep and dreamed of soft hugs, warm and slow. And he slept the whole night through.



Sleep now, little Hugo.

Sleep now, little Hugo.

The End

